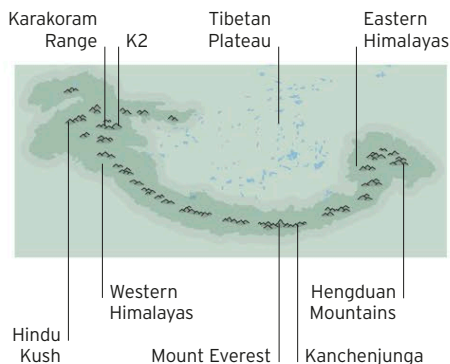




PARTS OF THE HIMALAYAS

Although one continuous arc of mountains, the Himalayas are considered to have two main parts: the Western and Eastern Himalayas. Many of the range's highest peaks, such as Everest, Lhotse, and Kanchenjunga, are clustered together in the eastern section. Neighboring mountain ranges, usually considered separate from the Himalayas, include the Karakoram and Hindu Kush to the northwest and Hengduan Mountains to the northeast. To the north of the Himalayas is the Tibetan Plateau.



The Himalayas

The world's highest mountain range, with more than 50 peaks reaching a height of 24,000 ft (7,200 m) or more



Running across northern Pakistan and India to Nepal and Bhutan, with some parts in China, the Himalayas are not only Earth's highest mountain range but also relatively young, having formed within the last 50 million years.

Abode of snow

Some 1,400 miles (2,300 km) long and 160–220 miles (250–350 km) wide, the Himalayas form a barrier between the Tibetan Plateau to the north and the plains of the Indian subcontinent to the south. The name of the range comes from the Sanskrit word *Himalaya*, which means “abode of snow.” Although extremely inhospitable, the highest peaks of the Himalayas present an irresistible magnet to mountaineers seeking the greatest possible challenges.



△ HIGH-ALTITUDE HUNTER

A few thousand snow leopards are believed to live in the Himalayas. In summer, their range extends as high as 20,000 ft (6,000 m).